

C1 PROFESSIONAL COMMUNICATION

Language for Construction Presentations

Phrase bank and presentational functions for construction project updates, client presentations, progress reports, and technical recommendations.

USE

Signposting, status,
risk, scope

LEVEL

Advanced / C1

FORMAT

Teacher handout +
phrase bank

Phrase Bank by Presentational Function

This handout organises the construction-presentation language from the lesson into functions: opening, signposting, progress updates, risk, evidence, costs, sustainability, client concerns, compliance, programme, recommendations, scope, and closing.

Teacher note

The phrases are best taught as presentation moves, not isolated vocabulary. Ask students: What is the speaker trying to do here - frame, reassure, justify, warn, recommend, or close? That question makes the language stick.

Presentation move	Useful language
Open	What I'd like to do today is... / walk you through...
Update	is proceeding in accordance with... / remains within budget
Explain	owing to... / arising from... / factoring in...
Justify	in light of... / informed by...
Manage risk	we have identified a potential delay / contingency plan in place
Recommend	It is our recommendation that... / prior to...
Close	To summarise... / on track to achieve practical completion

1. Opening and framing the presentation

Phrase	Presentational use	Example / note
What I'd like to do today is...	Sets the agenda politely and professionally.	<i>What I'd like to do today is walk you through the key milestones.</i>
walk you through...	Introduces a structured explanation or overview.	<i>I'll walk you through the project timeline.</i>
take you through...	Guides the audience step by step through information.	<i>Let me take you through the main design changes.</i>
guide you through...	Slightly more formal; useful for complex technical material.	<i>I'll guide you through the revised procurement process.</i>
the key milestones	Highlights the main achievements or project stages.	<i>We'll focus on the key milestones achieved this quarter.</i>
over the last quarter	Defines the reporting period.	<i>These are the milestones achieved over the last quarter.</i>

2. Signposting and transitions

Phrase	Presentational use	Example / note
Having covered...	Signals that one section is finished.	<i>Having covered procurement, let me now move on to delivery.</i>
let me now move on to...	Moves the presentation to the next topic naturally.	<i>Let me now move on to the on-site construction schedule.</i>
transition to...	A more formal way to change section or topic.	<i>We can now transition to the risk register.</i>
draw your attention to...	Directs the audience to an important point, slide, figure, or document.	<i>I'd like to draw your attention to the revised programme.</i>
in section three	Tells the audience where an issue will be addressed later.	<i>We will address this in section three.</i>
To summarise,...	Introduces the closing summary.	<i>To summarise, the project remains on track.</i>

3. Progress updates and project status

Phrase	Presentational use	Example / note
operating ahead of schedule	Reports positive progress against the timeline.	<i>We are currently operating ahead of schedule.</i>
ahead of the original programme	UK construction wording for being ahead of the planned sequence.	<i>Groundworks are three weeks ahead of the original programme.</i>
is proceeding in accordance with...	Formal way to say work is progressing according to plan.	<i>The fit-out phase is proceeding in accordance with the approved schedule.</i>
the approved schedule	Refers to the officially agreed timeline.	<i>The works remain aligned with the approved schedule.</i>
remains within budget	Reports positive financial status.	<i>The project remains within budget.</i>
is on track to achieve...	Says the project is progressing successfully toward a target.	<i>The development is on track to achieve BREEAM Excellent.</i>
upon completion	Refers to the final state of the project.	<i>The rating is expected upon completion.</i>
through to handover	Covers the period up to formal transfer/completion.	<i>The programme shows activities through to handover.</i>
by the contracted date	Refers to the official deadline in the contract.	<i>We expect practical completion by the contracted date.</i>
practical completion	Formal UK construction term for substantial completion.	<i>The target is to achieve practical completion in October.</i>

4. Explaining delays, causes, and reasons

Phrase	Presentational use	Example / note
largely owing to...	Formal way to explain the reason for a delay.	<i>The holdup was largely owing to late delivery of steel components.</i>
attributed to...	Assigns a cause, especially in passive structures.	<i>The delay was attributed to supply chain disruption.</i>
resulted from...	Explains the cause of a problem; avoid using it after 'was'.	<i>The delay resulted from a late supplier delivery.</i>
arising from...	Formal way to introduce the source of a problem or risk.	<i>A potential delay is arising from supply chain disruption.</i>
due to...	General causal phrase; useful but less formal.	<i>The work paused due to adverse weather.</i>
late delivery of...	Explains a delay caused by supply problems.	<i>There was a late delivery of structural steel components.</i>
supply chain disruption	Names a common cause of project delays.	<i>The cladding installation may be affected by supply chain disruption.</i>

5. Risk, issues, and uncertainty

Phrase	Presentational use	Example / note
identified several vulnerabilities	Presents weaknesses or risk points found during assessment.	<i>The survey identified several vulnerabilities.</i>
could affect the timeline	Explains the possible consequence of a risk.	<i>This could affect the timeline if left unaddressed.</i>
if left unaddressed	Warns what may happen if action is not taken.	<i>The issue may escalate if left unaddressed.</i>
we have identified a potential delay	Professional way to introduce a project risk.	<i>We have identified a potential delay to the cladding installation.</i>
a potential delay to...	Specifies the affected activity or phase.	<i>There is a potential delay to the cladding installation.</i>
Should ground conditions prove...	Formal conditional structure for discussing risk.	<i>Should ground conditions prove more challenging, we have a plan in place.</i>
than anticipated	Signals that actual conditions may differ from expectations.	<i>The soil conditions were more challenging than anticipated.</i>
a contingency plan in place	Reassures the audience that a backup plan exists.	<i>We have a contingency plan in place.</i>
avoid any impact on the critical path	Explains that the aim is to protect the overall project timeline.	<i>This will avoid any impact on the critical path.</i>
critical path	Project-management term for the task sequence that controls completion.	<i>The delay could affect the critical path.</i>

6. Evidence-based decisions and justification

Phrase	Presentational use	Example / note
in light of...	Shows that a decision was based on evidence or new information.	<i>The decision was made in light of the geotechnical investigation.</i>
following...	Introduces the event or information that came before a decision.	<i>Following the survey, the design was revised.</i>
the results of the geotechnical investigation	Gives technical evidence for an engineering decision.	<i>The foundation choice reflects the results of the geotechnical investigation.</i>
The decision to use... was made...	Formal way to explain and justify a design or engineering choice.	<i>The decision to use deep-pile foundations was made in light of the findings.</i>
factoring in...	Shows what has been considered in a calculation or decision.	<i>We've revised our estimates upwards, factoring in material costs.</i>
informed by...	Shows that evidence shaped a decision.	<i>The revised approach was informed by the site investigation.</i>

7. Costs, estimates, and financial changes

Phrase	Presentational use	Example / note
revised our estimates upwards	Explains that projected costs have increased.	<i>We've revised our estimates upwards since Q1.</i>
factoring in the increased cost of materials	Explains the reason for revised figures.	<i>The estimate has changed, factoring in the increased cost of materials.</i>
since Q1	Locates a financial change in time.	<i>Material costs have increased since Q1.</i>
remains within budget	Reassures stakeholders about financial control.	<i>Despite the revisions, the project remains within budget.</i>
cost projections	Refers to estimated future costs.	<i>Let's look at the revised cost projections.</i>

8. Environmental and sustainability language

Phrase	Presentational use	Example / note
environmental performance credentials	Formal phrase for sustainability-related achievements or standards.	<i>The project has strong environmental performance credentials.</i>
on track to achieve a BREEAM Excellent rating	Reports progress toward an environmental certification.	<i>The development is on track to achieve a BREEAM Excellent rating.</i>
to mitigate the environmental impact	Explains action taken to reduce environmental harm.	<i>We've used low-emission plant to mitigate the environmental impact.</i>
excavation works	Specific construction activity that may have environmental consequences.	<i>The excavation works are being monitored closely.</i>
low-emission plant machinery	Technical phrase for sustainability measures on site.	<i>Low-emission plant machinery has been used throughout.</i>
throughout	Shows that a measure has been applied consistently.	<i>This approach has been used throughout the works.</i>

9. Client concerns and stakeholder management

Phrase	Presentational use	Example / note
expressed reservations regarding...	Professional way to introduce client doubts or concerns.	<i>The client has expressed reservations regarding the materials specification.</i>
raised a number of concerns	Natural phrase for presenting stakeholder feedback.	<i>The client has raised a number of concerns.</i>
which we will address...	Reassures the audience that the issue will be dealt with later.	<i>This is something we will address in section three.</i>
the proposed materials specification	Formal phrase for the planned choice of materials.	<i>The proposed materials specification has been revised.</i>
the client's aesthetic brief	Refers to the client's design or style requirements.	<i>The design satisfies the client's aesthetic brief.</i>

10. Compliance, requirements, and design justification

Phrase	Presentational use	Example / note
satisfies the requirements	Formal way to say something meets required standards.	<i>The proposed design satisfies the planning authority's requirements.</i>
planning authority's requirements	Refers to official planning or legal requirements.	<i>The drawings address the planning authority's requirements.</i>
the client's aesthetic brief	Refers to the client's visual or design expectations.	<i>The design also satisfies the client's aesthetic brief.</i>
satisfies both... and...	Shows that a design balances multiple demands.	<i>The proposal satisfies both the authority's requirements and the client's brief.</i>
materials specification	Technical phrase for selected materials and standards.	<i>The materials specification has been updated.</i>

11. Programme and schedule language

Phrase	Presentational use	Example / note
the revised programme	UK construction term for the updated project schedule.	<i>Please refer to the revised programme.</i>
updated sequence of construction activities	Explains what the programme shows.	<i>The programme shows the updated sequence of construction activities.</i>
through to handover	Defines the programme's endpoint.	<i>The programme runs through to handover.</i>
approved schedule	Refers to the agreed timeline.	<i>The phase is proceeding in accordance with the approved schedule.</i>
construction schedule	General phrase for the project timeline.	<i>Let's review the construction schedule.</i>
on-site construction schedule	More specific phrase for work physically happening on site.	<i>The on-site construction schedule has been revised.</i>

12. Recommendations and approvals

Phrase	Presentational use	Example / note
It is our recommendation that...	Formal way to present a professional recommendation.	<i>It is our recommendation that the client approves the drawings.</i>
the client approves...	States the requested client action.	<i>We recommend that the client approves the revised drawings.</i>
the revised structural drawings	Refers to updated technical or design documents.	<i>The revised structural drawings are ready for review.</i>
prior to...	Formal alternative to 'before'.	<i>Approval is needed prior to the commencement of steelwork.</i>
prior to the commencement of steelwork	Formal construction phrase meaning before steelwork begins.	<i>The drawings must be approved prior to the commencement of steelwork.</i>
commencement of...	Formal noun phrase for the start of an activity.	<i>We expect commencement of steelwork next month.</i>

13. Scope, contracts, and variations

Phrase	Presentational use	Example / note
the works	Standard UK construction term for the project tasks or building work.	<i>The works fall outside the agreed contract scope.</i>
fall outside the agreed contract scope	Explains that something is not included in the original agreement.	<i>These additional works fall outside the agreed contract scope.</i>
are therefore subject to...	Shows a logical contractual consequence.	<i>The works are therefore subject to a variation order.</i>
a variation order	Contractual mechanism for changes to scope, price, or programme.	<i>A variation order will be required.</i>
agreed contract scope	The officially approved extent of work.	<i>This item is not within the agreed contract scope.</i>

14. Closing and summary statements

Phrase	Presentational use	Example / note
To summarise,...	Signals the final recap.	<i>To summarise, the project is on track.</i>
the project is on track...	Gives the audience a clear final status message.	<i>The project is on track to achieve practical completion.</i>
to achieve practical completion	Formal construction closing phrase.	<i>We remain on track to achieve practical completion.</i>
by the contracted date	Ends with a clear deadline-based assurance.	<i>Practical completion is expected by the contracted date.</i>

15. Phrases to be careful with

These expressions appear in or around the activity as weaker options, distractors, or context-dependent alternatives. They are useful to discuss because they show why 'correct English' and 'best presentation English' are not always the same thing.

Phrase	Presentational use	Example / note
caused through	Not standard in this context.	<i>Use caused by, due to, owing to, or arising from.</i>
henceforth	Means 'from now on'; not suitable for revised estimates.	<i>Use upwards/downwards or accordingly, depending on meaning.</i>
comprehensively	Means thoroughly; it does not show the direction of a cost change.	<i>Use upwards if projected costs have increased.</i>
redirect to	Suggests correcting course, not simply moving to the next presentation section.	<i>Use move on to or transition to.</i>
against the results	Suggests opposition or contradiction, not evidence-based decision-making.	<i>Use in light of or following.</i>
targeted to achieve	Awkward in the BREEAM sentence.	<i>Use on track to achieve, expected to achieve, or targeted at achieving.</i>
pursuant to	Very legalistic. Fine in contracts, heavy in spoken presentations.	<i>Use in light of, following, or under, depending on context.</i>

Core phrase set for students

A compact set worth drilling, recycling, and using in role-plays.

walk you through	draw your attention to	having covered... let me now move on to...
owing to	arising from	in light of
factoring in	ahead of schedule	in accordance with the approved schedule
on track to achieve	remains within budget	to mitigate the environmental impact
we have identified a potential delay	a contingency plan in place	It is our recommendation that
prior to the commencement of	fall outside the agreed contract scope	subject to a variation order
To summarise		

Classroom drill idea

Give students a simple project update and ask them to deliver it three ways: neutral, reassuring, and risk-focused. They should reuse the same facts but change the presentational function of the language.